WIKIPEDIA
The Free Encyclopedia

Biraja Temple

The **Biraja Temple**, or *Birija Kshetra* (Odia:ବିରଜା ମନ୍ଦିର, Birajā Kṣetra), is a historic Hindu temple located in Jajpur (about 125 kilometres (78 mi) north of Bhubaneswar), Odisha, India. The present temple was built during the 13th century.[1] The principal idol is Devi Durga, who is worshipped as Viraja (Girija), and the temple gave Jajpur the nicknames "Viraja Kshetra" and "Biraja Peetha". The Durga idol has two hands (*dwibhuja*), spearing the chest of Mahishasura with one hand and pulling his tail with the other. One of her feet is on a lion, and the other is on Mahishasura's chest. Mahishasura is depicted as a water buffalo. The idol's crown features Ganesha, a crescent moon and a lingam. The temple covers a large area, and has several shrines to Shiva and other deities. According to the *Skanda Purana* it cleanses pilgrims, and it is called the *Viraja* or the *Biraja kshetra*. Jajpur is believed to have about one crore of Shiva lingams.[2][3]

Biraja Temple	
ମା ବିରଜା ମନ୍ଦିର	
Maa Biraja Temple	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Jajpur
Deity	Biraja
Festivals	Durga Puja,Ratha Yatra
Location	
State	Odisha
Country	India
Odisha	
Coordinates	20°50′1.55″N 86°20′17.32″E
Architecture	
Style	Kalinga architecture
Completed	13th century

In Tantra

Maa Biraja Jajpur

The *Brahmayamala Tantra* has a hymn, "Aadya Stotra", dedicated to Shakti. In the hymn, Vimala is the goddess of Puri and Viraja (Girija) is the goddess worshipped in the Utkala Kingdom, which became Odisha.[4]

According to the *Tantra Chudamani*, Sati's navel fell in the Utkala Kingdom, also known as "Viraja kshetra". Adi Shankara, in his *Ashtadasha Shakti Peetha Stuti* describes the goddess as Girija. In Tantra literature, the Oddiyana Peetha (Devnagari:ओड्याण पीठ) is located in eastern India near the Vaitarani River (an Oddiyana is an ornament worn by a woman around her navel).[5]

Sree Bagalamukhi Deity

There is a separate shrine for Sree Bagalamukhi Devi, which is right of Maa Biraja. One can find very few temples for this Roopa of Dasamahavidya.[6]

Front view from left side of Viraja(also named as Biraja) Temple

Nabhi Gaya

Pitapuram holds the Pada Gaya, the Sira Gaya is found in Bihar, the Nabhi Gaya is found here in the form of a well. Pitru Pooja (Pinda Daan, Tarpan, Tithi) are performed here. The temple itself arranges the priests and the pooja items.[6]

Rituals and festivals

The primary ritual in the temple is Sharadiya Durga Puja, which begins on the night of Krishna Paksha Ashtami. This falls before Mahalaya, and ends on Ashwin Shukla Paksha Navami. The *puja*, known as Shodasha Dinatatmika Puja, lasts for 16 days. The *ratha* (chariot festival) is known as Simhadhwaja, and its flag bears a lion. During the lunar transition from Shukla Ashtami to Shukla Navami an animal sacrifice, *Bali Daanam*, is performed. Navratri is celebrated as *Aparajita Puja*.[6]

Ratha Jatra of Maa Biraja, Jajpur

Other festivals include Nakshatra, Shravana, Prathamastami, Pana Sankranti, Raja Parva and Navanna. Devi is worshipped daily in accordance with Tantra and Agama traditions as Mahishasuramardini by the Brahmins of Jajpur.[6]

Transportation

The nearest railway station is Cuttack and Jajpur Keonjhar Road. From there regular buses can be availed to Jajpur town. Mostly private buses run regularly in Orissa. Autos connect Cuttack railway station to Badambadi bus stand, which is hardly 3 km away. The bus from Cuttack to Jajapur town takes 2 to 2½ hours. From Jajpur road to Jajpur town travelling time by road will be more than one hour. Also buses are available from Bhubaneswar. Buses which have express written on the buses are quicker than local buses.

Accommodation

A couple of lodges are next to the temple and another is being constructed.many hotels and lodges also within 2 km radius.

See also

- Yajna Varaha Temple
- Oddiyana

References

1. Chavan, Akshay (26 September 2023). "Biraja Temple - In the Heart of the Biraja Kshetra" (https://www.peepultree.world/livehistoryindia/story/places/biraja-temple-in-the-heart-of-the-biraja-kshetra). *PeepulTree*. Retrieved 13 March 2025.
2. "18 Maha Shakthi Peeths" (https://www.speakingtree.in/allslides/18-maha-shakthi-peeths). *www.speakingtree.in*. Retrieved 13 March 2025.
3. Shankar, Ravi (3 October 2021). "Motherlodes of Power: The story of India's 'Shakti Peethas' " (https://www.newindianexpress.com/magazine/2021/Sep/26/motherlodesof-power-2362905.html). *The New Indian Express*. Retrieved 13 March 2025.
4. "Shakti Peeth Biraja Mandir, Jajpur, Odisha" (https://hindupost.in/dharma-religion/shakti-peeth-biraja-mandir-jajpur-odisha/#). *hindupost.in*. 10 March 2025. Retrieved 13 March 2025.
5. Chavan, Akshay (26 September 2023). "Biraja Temple - In the Heart of the Biraja Kshetra" (https://www.peepultree.world/livehistoryindia/story/places/biraja-temple-in-the-heart-of-the-biraja-kshetra). *PeepulTree*. Retrieved 13 March 2025.
6. "Shakti Peeth Biraja Mandir, Jajpur, Odisha" (https://hindupost.in/dharma-religion/shakti-peeth-biraja-mandir-jajpur-odisha/#). *hindupost.in*. 10 March 2025. Retrieved 13 March 2025.

- More About Temples Jajpur (https://web.archive.org/web/20150801105412/http://myodia.com/category/famous-temples-in-odisha/page/2)
- Trilochaneswar Temple of Jajpur (https://web.archive.org/web/20150614140911/http://myodia.com/trilochaneswar-temple-of-jajpur.html)
- Biraja Temple Official Website (http://www.maabiraja.com/)
- Pictures of Biraja Temple (https://web.archive.org/web/20101223031411/http://ignca.nic.in/asp/all.asp?projectid=orjjp0590001)
- Report on Biraja Temple (https://web.archive.org/web/20110621221523/http://ignca.nic.in/asi_reports/orjajpur059.pdf)
- 51 Shakti peetha, Viraja among shakti peetha (http://www.shaktipeethas.org/panchasat/topic191.html) Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20150518105442/http://www.shaktipeethas.org/panchasat/topic191.html) 18 May 2015 at the Wayback Machine

External links

- Yoga Guru's visit to Oddiyana Viraja Temple and Nabhi Gaya Photos (http://www.dattapeetham.com/india/tours/2010/assam-orissa/orissa/orissa-2010.html)

- Oddyane Girija Devi (http://sekharnpc-howjyothirlingascanbe14.blogspot.com/2009/09/18-shakti-peeth-ashta-dasha-shakti.html)
- Maa Biraja Website Developer & Adviser (https://www.bkgraphy.co.in)
- Maa Biraja Devi Shakti Peeth Darshan Full Video (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aPdbgg_-Z4s)

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Biraja_Temple&oldid=1321884801"